Here is a different case which, many think, the Probability Splitting Rule says just the right thing about.

The poll

I put an argument on the screen, and conduct a poll, asking you to say whether the argument is valid or invalid. You confidently answer "Valid." When the poll results show up, you find to your surprise that you are the only student who answered this way.

What should you say in this case? Why?

Why? We can think of this as a case in which you have many simultaneous disagreements. Supposing for simplicity that everyone initially has credence 1 in her answer, the Probability Splitting Rule would suggest that you should lower your credence in your initial answer to 0.5, then to 0.25, then to 0.125, then to .... a small number.

Does the probability splitting rule have any practical consequences?

Consider any religious, moral, or political view you have. There would seem to be plenty of people who have the same evidence as you, have thought about the issues as much as you, and are as smart as you, who have a view opposite to yours.

This suggests an argument with massive consequences for what you believe about these domains.

the disagreement → agnosticism argument

1. For every moral, political, of religious view you have, you have at least roughly as many epistemic peers who disagree with you as you have epistemic peers who agree with you.
2. The probability-splitting rule.

C. You should not have credence >0.5 about any moral, political, or religious view. (1,2)

Is this argument convincing?

The second argument is simpler. The main point is that this rule makes the facts about what we ought to believe oddly hostage to the beliefs of others.

It seems as though it should be possible to be a rational and self-aware radical. That is, it should be possible to rationally hold a belief despite the fact (i) a majority of your peers disagree with you and (ii) you know that a majority of your peers disagree with you. In order for this to happen, must it be the case that the people who disagree with you are not really your epistemic peers?

Probability-splitting

If you assign P credence N, and come across an epistemic peer who assigns P credence M, then you should change your credence in P to the average of N and M.

The opposite of Probability-Splitting is the view that I should give no weight at all to the fact that people disagree with me. The mere fact of disagreement, after all, is no argument against the truth of any of my beliefs.

The central challenge for this position are the cases mentioned at the outset, like the horse race and check-splitting.

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